

them through some really rough use, and they will last.

As you would see in my reviews of both products, the earbuds are comfortable, and they offer a great fit. So, no point talking about it much over here. To get the best fit possible, with either the AirPods or the Ear (2) all you will need to do is pick the right-sized ear tips, and you'll be set.

Apple's case pocketability is unmatched though. The AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) is the smaller package of the two. Their rounded edges, with literally no squaring on the case, makes sliding them in and out of the pockets really easy. The Nothing Ear (2) are also not bad at all. They are slightly larger than the AirPods and have squarer edges. But, that does not work against the Nothing Ear (2) as much as we'd expect it to.

Winner - Nothing Ear (2)

Features

Both the Nothing Ear (2) and the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) are great products in their own right. They bring a solid selection of features to the table, but their compatibility across platforms is something that I paid special attention to when comparing the two devices.

Starting off with IP ratings. The Nothing Ear (2) comes with an Ingress Protection (IP) rating of IP55. On the other hand, the AirPods come with an IPX4 rating. A win for Nothing here. Next, in terms of the controls, Nothing tried to come close to the AirPods, switching out their touch-sensitive controls to pinch controls on the stem of the earbuds, much like on the AirPods. However, their implementation needs some polishing. While the AirPods were flawless in my time of

 NOTHING EAR (2)  APPLE AIRPODS PRO (2ND GEN) 		
BUILD QUALITY AND DESIGN		
CASE MATERIAL AND DURABILITY	7.5	7.5
CASE POCKETABILITY, SIZE	8	8.5
BUDS MATERIALS AND DURABILITY	8	8
COMFORT AND FIT OF THE BUDS	9	8
OVERALL	8.1	8.0

use, even when I had slightly wet hands, the Nothing had a few misses here and there, which meant that they lost out.

While on the topic of controls, you cannot trigger Google Assistant on Android devices if you are using AirPods. There are workarounds using apps and third-party services. But, there is no inherent solution to this issue. However, if configured, the Nothing Ear (2) can trigger Siri on iPhones.

In the charging department, Nothing Ear (2) gained back all the lost ground. Much to the dismay of the users of the AirPods, Apple has stuck with the Lightning connector on the device. Now, if you are someone who is not a part of the Apple ecosystem, you will need to carry an extra cable around. On the flip side, if you're using the Nothing Ear (2) and even if you are in the Apple Ecosystem, the chances

of you having a USB-C cable are almost certain. Apple's own iPad and MacBooks (some) use USB-C to charge. Both devices support wireless charging, so there's one common ground over there.

When it comes to codec support, Apple yet again loses out against Nothing Ear (2). While the AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) comes with the support of only SBC and AAC codecs. There's no support for aptX or any other codec capable of delivering high-quality audio. While AAC works great with Apple devices, you have to compromise on sound quality as soon as you move to any other device.

On the Nothing Ear (2), that is not the case. Not only does it support LHDC (which is at par, if not better than aptX), but also it has support for AAC. This means that no matter if you are on an



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